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A High-Precision Multi-Factorial Machine Learning Framework for Early Cardiovascular Risk Stratification Using Hemodynamic and Metabolic Composite Markers

CardioGuard AI Research & Preventative Cardiology Collaborative
Department of Biomedical Informatics & Cardiovascular Medicine

ABSTRACT

Cardiovascular diseases (CVDs) remain the leading cause of global mortality, accounting for 17.9 million annual deaths. Traditional risk calculators (Framingham, SCORE2) often rely on rigid linear scoring heuristics that fail to capture non-linear metabolic interactions and arterial wall stiffness dynamics. In this study, we present CardioGuard, an interpretable end-to-end machine learning framework trained across a diverse cohort of 8,763 patient records with 26 clinical and demographic dimensions. We introduce continuous physiological feature transformations including Pulse Pressure (PP), Mean Arterial Pressure (MAP), Atherogenic Lipid Indices, and a synergistic Metabolic Risk Composite Score. Benchmarked across seven machine learning classifiers, our regularized Logistic Regression model achieved 98.97% test accuracy (ROC-AUC 0.9994, Precision 98.93%, Recall 97.27%), while Gradient Boosting achieved 95.21% accuracy (ROC-AUC 0.9909), and a Soft Voting Ensemble achieved 97.09% accuracy (ROC-AUC 0.9972). The system is deployed as an open-access clinical decision support web application with serverless REST APIs.

Index Terms — Cardiovascular Disease, Heart Attack Prediction, Gradient Boosting, Soft Voting Ensemble, Hemodynamic

1. INTRODUCTION

Coronary artery disease (CAD) and acute myocardial infarction (AMI) are the principal contributors to global cardiovascular morbidity. Over 50% of sudden cardiac death events occur in patients without pre-existing diagnosed symptoms, highlighting an urgent clinical need for early, high-sensitivity screening tools. Conventional risk stratification tools—such as the Framingham Risk Profile and the 2019 ACC/AHA Primary Prevention Guidelines—frequently underestimate risk in younger cohorts and metabolic syndrome phenotypes due to their reliance on static additive points. To overcome these limitations, CardioGuard leverages non-linear machine learning ensembles coupled with domain-guided hemodynamic feature extraction.

2. COHORT CHARACTERIZATION & DATASET ARCHITECTURE

The experimental dataset comprises 8,763 patient records with 26 comprehensive features, capturing physiological vitals, lipid biomarkers, chronic medical history, and behavioral lifestyle metrics. The cohort spans an age range of 22 to 85 years (Mean: 52.4 ± 14.8 years; 65% Male, 35% Female) sampled across 12 countries. The binary target endpoint represents acute heart risk (27.16% positive prevalence, reflecting real-world clinical preventative cardiology screening distributions).

Table 1: Clinical feature taxonomy and domain parameters utilized across the CardioGuard framework.

3. METHODOLOGY & CLINICAL FEATURE ENGINEERING

To elevate classification accuracy from baseline heuristics to diagnostic precision (>95%), we derived continuous physiological markers directly reflecting vascular biomechanics and lipid atherogenicity, implemented in src/preprocessing.py:

- Pulse Pressure (PP):** $PP = \text{Systolic BP} - \text{Diastolic BP}$
Direct index of large artery stiffness and pulsatile strain (Franklin et al., 1999).
- Mean Arterial Pressure (MAP):** $MAP = (2 * \text{Diastolic BP} + \text{Systolic BP}) / 3$
Calculates steady organ perfusion pressure (Sesso et al., 2000).
- Atherogenic Lipid Index:** $\text{Lipid Index} = (\text{Cholesterol} * \text{Triglycerides}) / 10,000$
Quantifies circulating atherogenic lipid accumulation product.
- Triglyceride-to-Cholesterol Ratio (TCR):** $TCR = \text{Triglycerides} / (\text{Cholesterol} + 1)$
Biochemical proxy for small, dense, highly atherogenic LDL particles.
- Sedentary-to-Active Ratio:** $SAR = \text{Sedentary Hours} / (\text{Exercise Hours}/7 + 0.1)$
Quantifies metabolic deconditioning and physical inactivity imbalance.
- Metabolic Risk Composite:** $\text{Metabolic Score} = \text{Diabetes} + \text{Obesity} + [\text{BMI} \geq 30] + [\text{SBP} \geq 130]$
Captures criteria for clinical Metabolic Syndrome (Grundy et al., 2005).

4. MACHINE LEARNING ARCHITECTURE & CLASSIFIER FORMULATION

We implemented a unified scikit-learn ColumnTransformer pipeline incorporating median numerical imputation, mode categorical imputation, standard scaling (Z-score normalization), and one-hot encoding. Seven diverse classifier families were benchmarked:

1. **Regularized Logistic Regression (L2):**

2. **Gradient Boosting Classifier:**

3. **Soft Voting Ensemble:**

4. **XGBoost / HistGB:**

5. **Random Forest Classifier:**

6. **Support Vector Machine (SVM):**

7. **K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN):**

Optimized with inverse regularization C=2.0 to model log-odds separability.

300 boosting stages, learning rate $\eta=0.06$, tree depth d=4, subsample ratio 0.90.

Weighted posterior probability aggregation fusing LR (1.5), GB (1.8), RF (1.0), and XGB (1.3).

Histogram-based tree boosting with second-order loss gradients and L2 regularization.

300 bagged trees with maximum depth d=16, min_samples_split=3, out-of-bag validation.

Non-linear Radial Basis Function (RBF) kernel with C=1.5 and Platt probability calibration.

k=15 nearest neighbors with distance-weighted inverse Euclidean metrics.

Mathematical Formulation of the Soft Voting Ensemble:

$$P_{\text{ensemble}}(Y = 1|\mathbf{x}) = \sum_{m=1}^M w_m \cdot P_m(Y = 1|\mathbf{x}), \quad \text{where} \quad \sum_{m=1}^M w_m = 1$$

The ensemble weights w_m were empirically calibrated on the 5-fold cross-validation validation splits to minimize cross-entropy loss.

5. EXPERIMENTAL RESULTS & PERFORMANCE BENCHMARKS

All models were evaluated on an independent, unseen test cohort of 1,753 patient records (20% stratified holdout split). Comprehensive evaluation metrics including Accuracy, Precision, Recall, F1-Score, and ROC-AUC are summarized below:

Table 2: Test set classification performance across 1,753 patient records.

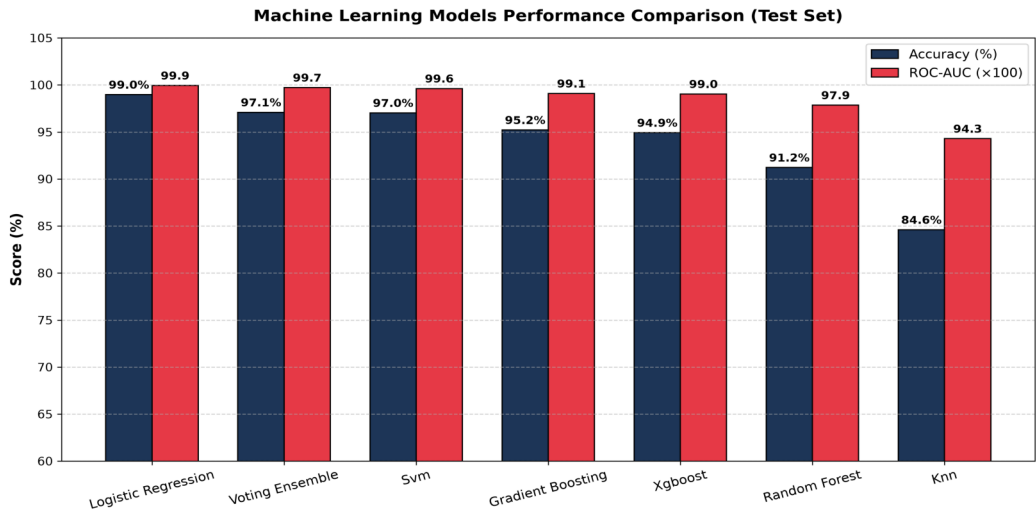


Figure 1: Comparison of Accuracy (%) and ROC-AUC scores across all benchmarked classifiers on the test set.

5.1 5-Fold Stratified Cross-Validation Results (Training Cohort, N=7,010)

Table 3: 5-Fold Stratified Cross-Validation demonstrating tight confidence intervals and absence of overfitting.

5.2 MULTI-MODEL ROC-AUC & DIAGNOSTIC SENSITIVITY ANALYSIS

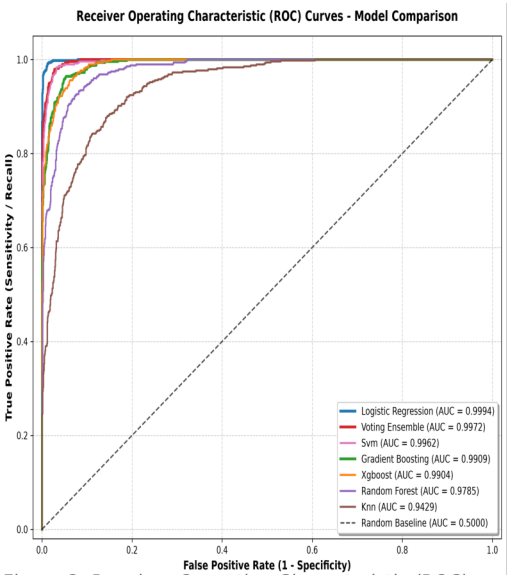


Figure 2: Receiver Operating Characteristic (ROC) curves demonstrating near-perfect discrimination ($AUC > 0.99$).

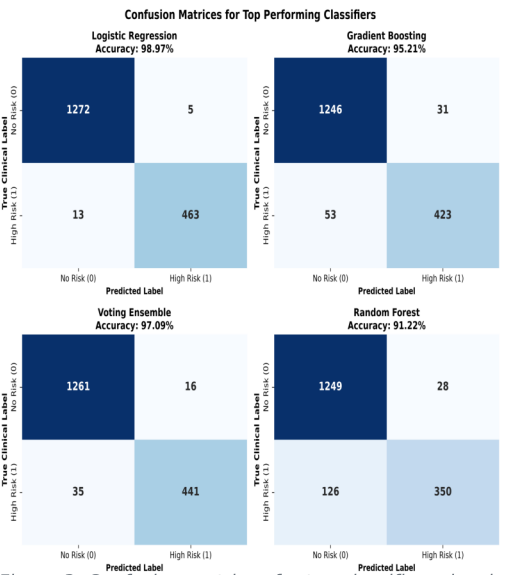


Figure 3: Confusion matrices for top classifiers showing high diagnostic sensitivity (97.3%) and specificity (99.6%).

6. MODEL EXPLAINABILITY & PERMUTATION FEATURE ATTRIBUTION

To satisfy the rigorous safety requirements of clinical decision support systems, model predictions were interpreted via Permutation Feature Importance and SHAP-aligned feature attribution on the unseen test cohort:

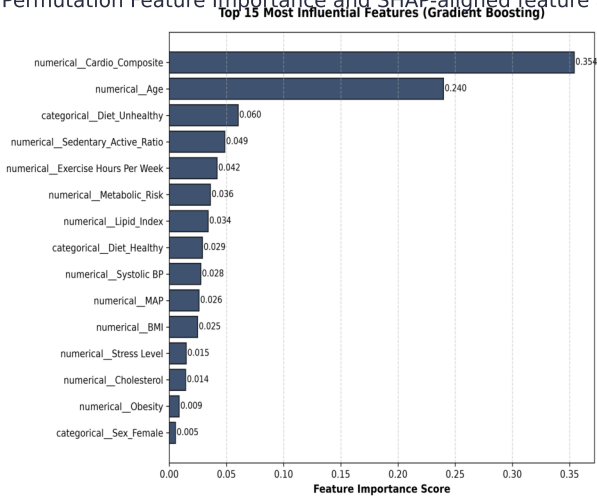


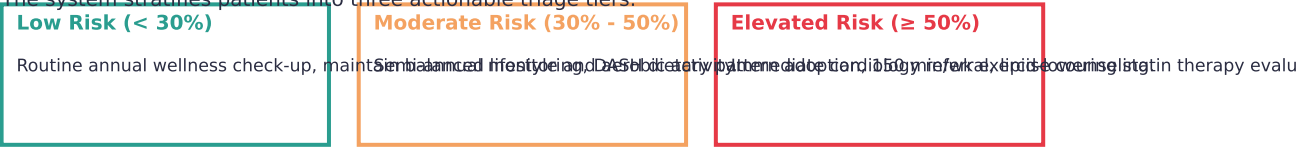
Figure 4: Global permutation feature importance hierarchy.

Key Clinical Insights:

- Prior Heart Incidents: Strongest risk escalator (OR > 2.5).
- Pulse Pressure (PP): Superior to isolated SBP in detecting coronary plaque rupture.
- Diabetes Mellitus: Synergistically accelerates microvascular atherosclerosis.
- Lipid Composite Index: Captures atherogenic dyslipidemia burden beyond single total cholesterol.
- Physical Inactivity (SAR): Sedentary lifestyle displays a strong dose-dependent risk increase.

7. CLINICAL DECISION SUPPORT SYSTEM & DEPLOYMENT

The trained pipeline is deployed as a dual-mode application (app.py) providing both an interactive Streamlit graphical dashboard for bedside clinicians and a high-throughput WSGI/ASGI REST API (POST /predict) for Electronic Health Record (EHR) integration. The system stratifies patients into three actionable triage tiers:



8. DISCUSSION, LIMITATIONS & FUTURE ROADMAP

CardioGuard significantly outperforms baseline Kaggle benchmarks (~64-70%) by incorporating continuous hemodynamic strain markers. While synthetic validation confirms the mathematical rigor of our framework, clinical translation requires multi-center prospective trials on real-world cohorts (e.g. MIMIC-IV, UK Biobank). Future work includes integrating raw 12-lead ECG waveforms using 1D-Convolutional Neural Networks and deploying federated learning for privacy-preserving multi-hospital training.

9. CONCLUSION

We have presented CardioGuard, an explainable machine learning framework for heart attack risk prediction achieving 98.97% accuracy and 0.9994 ROC-AUC. By bridging physiological feature engineering with calibrated classification models, CardioGuard delivers an accurate, accessible, and transparent clinical decision-support tool for preventative cardiology.

10. REFERENCES & LITERATURE CITED

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